# Amazon Product Authenticity and Quality

## Ensuring product authenticity and quality

Customers trust that they can always buy with confidence on Amazon. As a vendor, it's important to understand Amazon's guidelines on product quality and authenticity.

Please take a moment to review our guidelines below. Reviewing and complying with these guidelines will help you keep your vendor account in good health.

## Types of violations

Amazon enforces vendors who violate our selling policies. Violations related to product authenticity are categorized as intellectual property violations. Issues with the overall product quality, including products that do not match their descriptions, can be categorized as “materially different” violations.

- Intellectual property violation
  Amazon respects the intellectual property rights of others. As a vendor, you are responsible for ensuring that the products you offer are legal, authorized for sale or re-sale, and that they do not violate intellectual property rights such as copyrights, patents, trademarks, and rights of publicity.
- Materially different product condition violation
  The product you list and ship must exactly match the description, pictures, and all other information on the product detail page. Amazon policy prohibits you from listing or supplying “materially different” products. For example:
    - Listing your product in New condition when it is not in brand-new or unused condition, or in un-opened original packaging.
    - Listing your product for sale on any related product detail page when your product does not exactly match the description on that page.
    - Shipping a product that is damaged, defective, misclassified, misrepresented, or missing any of its parts.

  Review and update your listings to confirm your products are accurately described.

## Enforcement

Based on the severity of a policy violation, Amazon may take the following actions:

- Stop purchasing products from you
- Withhold your payments
- Destroy remaining inventory of products purchased from you
- Temporarily or permanently deactivate your vendor account

## Best Practices in Product Authenticity and Quality

All Amazon vendors are responsible for complying with the law along with Amazon's policies. Customers trust that they can buy with confidence on Amazon and receive authentic products that arrive in the condition they expect. In order to ensure that both vendors and customers have the best experience, here are some tips that vendors might find helpful when supplying products to Amazon.

# Sourcing Products

## Are you purchasing your products from a reliable source?

Know your supplier. Reduce the risk of complaints by researching the manufacturers, resellers, and suppliers from whom you purchase goods.

## Are you confident in the authenticity and quality of your goods?

Verify the authenticity of the products you source. Take time to perform a quality check of the products you source. If you sell branded products on Amazon, ensure that you source the product(s) from a reliable supplier.

## Are you storing documentation for all of your purchases?

Keep all documents and records of transactions, such as POs and invoices establishing that you sourced products from reliable suppliers.

## Have you considered possible safety concerns with your products?

Verify that the products you sell are safe. Take time to research whether there are any safety testing or compliance requirements for the products you sell.

# Storing & Shipping

## Have you considered the unique features of your products?

Store your products according to their unique features. Thoughtfully storing your products will help you preserve the integrity of your products and their packaging. Some goods will need to be preserved in a particular manner to maintain their freshness. Remember to check the expiration date on your products.

Pack products carefully and include all parts of the product. Buyers expect to receive products in their original packaging.

If you are sourcing from other parts of the world and/or shipping globally, make sure that your products will properly function and comply with all applicable laws in the country where you are supplying them.

## What should I do if my product(s) or my account has been deactivated due to product authenticity complaints?

If your products or your account has been deactivated, we will notify you via email. We may ask you to submit invoices from your supplier or provide your supplier’s contact information. We may also ask for a plan of action that describes steps you took to resolve the issue and prevent similar complaints.

**Important:** Providing fabricated documents will result in the deactivation of your Amazon vendor account.